

THE WHITE HOUSE
WASHINGTON
POLICY MEMORANDUM

DATE: March 2nd, 2026

FROM: Megan Fife

SOURCES: [Times of Isreal](#), [Kurdistan24](#), [The Defense Post](#), [Somaliguardian](#),

TOPIC: Somaliland Minister Offers U.S. Access to Bases and Minerals

ISSUE: Whether the U.S. will accept access to military bases and minerals in Somaliland. Somaliland's Minister, Khadir Hussein Adbi, made this offer in an Agence France-Presse (AFP) interview on Saturday, February 21.

BACKGROUND: Somaliland officials have declared, with little independent confirmation, that lithium, coltan, etc. used in batteries and electric vehicles are available. Somaliland has declared independence since 1991 with its own currency, army, passports and police force. Isreal recognized the Republic of Somaliland on December 26, 2025, which the African Union and most Arab countries condemned. Somaliland President, Abdirahman Mohamed Abdullahi, suggested granting privileges to mineral and base rights to Isreal as well in exchange for technology like the U.S offer. Somaliland believes, "...we will agree on something..." assuming the U.S. will give a declaration of sovereignty but, President Trump stated he's unlikely to even with Republican support.

OPTIONS:

1. Recognize Somaliland as a sovereign nation and reap the benefits.
Action: Establish bases and access to mineral rights in Somaliland.
Pros: Gain militaristic capabilities in the horn of Africa and minerals, it will please Isreal and lessen our independence on China.
Cons: Might anger the African Union and most Arab countries and it may be seen as siding with Isreal.
2. Stick with not recognizing Somaliland as a sovereign nation.
Action: Do not take the offer to access bases and the mineral rights of Somaliland.
Pros: Will not anger the African Union and most Arab countries.
Cons: Lose out on mineral and military access to the region.
3. Prioritize economic relations and do not engage in political recognition.
Action: Accept the mineral rights and base access but only if it means we don't have to recognize Somaliland sovereignty.

Pros: Gain mineral rights critical for electronics, lessens our dependence on China, and most Arab nations and the African Union countries will be satisfied.

Cons: Seen as a halfway stand, Somaliland may be unsatisfied and feel used.

RECOMMENDATION: That you approve Option 3. Do not recognize Somaliland as a sovereign nation and still possibly reap the benefits of mineral rights and base access. This puts U.S. national security and its economy as the highest priority and indicates interest in the region without angering neighbors.

